## Current Situation

Since the EdgePoint Consulting Merger (EPC), Stratus Solutions Group (SSG) has seen an increase in internal flaws that impact day-to-day operations. Teams are struggling with overlapping VP duties, incompatible technology platforms, and growing anger with management. If these issues are not resolved quickly, they will have a detrimental impact on SSG's external client relationships and undercut its efforts to maintain professionalism.

## Background

SSG and EPC merged on March 1, 2026. This acquisition adds approximately 100 new employees to SSG's already 1,000 person staff. This will help to increase the company's consulting depth, operational capacity, and overall regional growth. First, leadership and department positions are "overlapping" and "fluid" because of the merger. Second, the usage of three technology platforms hindered collaboration and increased confusion. Finally, the blending of two different cultures poses immediate challenges.

## Analysis

*Problematic Platform and Process Use*

Employees are using multiple technology platforms. Right now, documents are stored in SharePoint, Google Workplace, One Drive, Google Drive and employee local drives. A supervisor said they added files to a team folder on SharePoint, but some team members are using the legacy portal. This negatively impacts communication and efficiency within the company. When working on assignments like analyzing Q1 adjustments, employees are showing inconsistent file management. One supervisor said, “I think it was version 3, but let me know if there’s a newer one floating around.” This lack of organization creates confusion, leads to inefficiencies, and prevents the team from performing at its full potential.

*Overlapping Roles and Communication*

Employees are confused since leadership positions and responsibilities were not clearly established following the merger. A background memo says that there are "areas of natural overlap" and that department roles would remain "fluid," making it difficult for employees to determine who is responsible for certain tasks and decisions. This lowers accountability since staff are left to interpret their duties rather than following a defined chain of command. As a result, communication becomes less consistent, and tasks are more prone to overlap. That confusion is visible in the Blue Horizon webinar exchanges. Leah told Jamie, “Go ahead and halt any prep for now… Let’s pause everything related to this until we get a firm go-ahead from their side,” but Amelia was later asked to prepare materials for the same project. When employees receive conflicting instructions for the same assignment, they are unsure what to follow. This causes wasted effort, confusing messages, and inefficient teamwork throughout the company.

*Culture*

Culture is an essential component of a successful merger, but SSG is already showing signs of cultural clash. According to a background article, combining two firms with "distinct cultures, systems, and workflows may present ongoing challenges," and those challenges are already showing themselves throughout the company. Employees are entering the merger with different habits, expectations, and ways of working, which makes it harder to build one consistent workplace culture. Without a clearer unified approach, frustration is likely to keep increasing. That problem becomes apparent even more in SSG's post-merger intranet statement. According to the organization, "there is no single required approach for collaboration, communication, procedures, meetings, etc.," which means staff follow

different procedures and have different expectations. While flexibility might seem beneficial during a change, it really makes integration more difficult because employees are not operating from the same standard. Over time, this could weaken unity and compromise the merger's success.

## Recommendation

*Problematic Platform and Process Use*

Roles and responsibilities must be clarified. Currently, SSG's document platforms and file processes are causing confusion and slowing down employee work. Documents are being stored across multiple systems, which makes it harder for employees to know where files belong and which version is correct. This issue also weakens accountability and decreases productivity. To overcome this, the following steps should be taken:

1. Choose one approved document management system for all active files. Document systems are most effective when files are kept in one central location (Computhink, 2025).
2. Move active files into that system, delete duplicates, and archive outdated documents. This would improve organization and reduce confusion across teams (Computhink, 2025).
3. Create one standard for file names, and version labels and then train employees to follow it. Version control and clear workflows are important parts of an effective document management process (Computhink, 2025)

By following this recommendation, SSG can create a more organized process, reduce confusion, and improve teamwork in both the short term and the long term.

*Overlapping Roles and Communication*

Roles and responsibilities must be clarified. Currently, overlapping leadership duties and inconsistent communication are creating confusion across SSG. Employees are receiving different instructions from leaders, which makes it harder to know who is responsible for decisions and what work should move forward. This issue also weakens accountability, causes work to overlap, and makes teamwork less efficient. To overcome this, the following steps should be taken:

1. Review leadership roles, and decision-making responsibilities. In mergers, leaders should first explain how work gets done so they can identify differences that may create friction (Oliver Engert, 2019)
2. Define clear decision rights for each leader and department. Organizations work more effectively when they move away from unclear roles and toward clearly defined responsibilities (Oliver Engert, 2019)
3. Create one shared responsibility chart for major tasks, approvals, and project decisions. This would give employees a clear reference point and reduce overlap.
4. Use one consistent process for assigning work, running meetings, and communicating updates. Clearer decision rights and more disciplined meetings can improve accountability and streamline decision-making (Oliver Engert, 2019).
5. Track the new process through employee feedback, and leadership check-ins. Merger-related changes should be monitored so leaders can identify problems and respond to them quickly (Oliver Engert, 2019).

By following this recommendation, SSG can reduce mixed messages, strengthen accountability, and create a more efficient leadership structure in both the short term and the long term.

*Culture*

Culture must be unified. Currently, SSG does not have one clear set of expectations for collaboration, communication, and daily work, which is making the merger harder for employees to adjust to. When employees are left to follow different norms and procedures, it creates confusion, frustration, and a weaker sense of unity across the company. This issue can also hurt morale and make the merger less successful over time. To overcome this, the following steps should be taken:

1. Establish a shared cultural vision for the new organization. A clear and common direction helps reduce ambiguity during a merger (Kapoor, 2025).
2. Ask employees what they hope changes, what stays the same, and where they see cultural differences. Team input helps leaders identify concerns and understand where better alignment is needed (Kapoor, 2025).
3. Set clear communication expectations for collaboration and daily work. Employees need those expectations to adjust to the new culture more effectively (Kapoor, 2025)
4. Define the values and behaviors SSG wants employees to demonstrate. Shared values can build trust, reduce resistance, and support a more unified culture, as (Kapoor, 2025) notes.
5. Embed those values into hiring, training, and performance reviews. Building desired behaviors into HR systems helps reinforce the culture over time (Kapoor, 2025).

By following this recommendation, SSG can create a more unified culture, reduce employee frustration, and build a stronger foundation for long-term success after the merger.

## Conclusion

SSG's inefficiencies come primarily from internal confusion following the merger. If these issues persist, they will complicate daily tasks and may eventually harm client relationships and the company's professionalism. By improving its internal procedures and giving clearer objectives, SSG can reduce confusion and help employees work more effectively. These adjustments would address the company's existing issues while also providing a clearer route forward. Overall, taking action now will help SSG become more organized and better prepared for long term success.

## References

Computhink, Inc. (2025, December 1). *Document management system: Everything organizations need to know.* Retrieved from Computhink.

Kapoor, B. (2025, February 5). *20 ways leaders successfully merge organizational cultures during M&A*. Retrieved from Forbes: https://www.forbes.com/councils/forbeshumanresourcescouncil/2025/02/05/20-ways-leaders-successfully-merge-organizational-cultures-during-ma/

Engert, O., Kaetzler, B., Kordestani, K., & MacLean, A . (2019, March). *Organizational culture in mergers: Addressing the unseen forces.* McKinsey & Company. Retrieved from McKinsey & Company.